GEC1044 Group Fieldwork- A Simple Guide

The Group Fieldwork project is an opportunity to practise research in a real-world setting. You are expected not only to collect information from your chosen Chinese medicine hall, but also to analyse what your findings reveal about Traditional Chinese Medicine in Singapore. The questions you ask, the way you interpret responses, and the conclusions you develop should demonstrate your ability to conduct fieldwork, apply course concepts, and think critically.

You may choose any medicine hall within your assigned area; there is no fixed list. Please note the distinction between **medical halls** and **TCM clinics**: medical halls sell herbal ingredients and other medicinal products, while TCM clinics provide medical consultation and treatment. For this project, you should visit **medicine halls**, not clinics. It is up to your group whether to contact the medicine hall in advance. However, prior notice may sometimes lead to refusal, so it is advisable to have a backup option.

Your **Week 7/8** presentation should be kept to **10–15 minutes**. The main focus should be your chosen medicine hall, as this is the subject of your fieldwork. At the same time, you may use your case study to reflect on broader issues relating to TCM, where relevant. For example, you might begin with the specific details of the business or place, then consider the wider cultural, commercial, or social meanings behind the information you have gathered.

The group report, due in **Week 9**, should build on your presentation, incorporate feedback, and include further analysis where appropriate. You may also refer to additional materials, such as articles or documentaries, as long as they are relevant and properly credited.

There will be **no fixed rubric** for this assignment. Your work will be assessed holistically, based on the overall quality of your fieldwork, the depth of your analysis, and the clarity of your presentation and report. This approach gives you flexibility in shaping your project and encourages you to think beyond a checklist.

Fieldwork may not always go as planned, but that is part of the research process. What matters most is not simply the information you collect, but how you interpret it to offer meaningful insights into Chinese medicine in Singapore today.

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